Ejercicio del 21/04/2026

2.4 Was your mom living here when you were born? English ID 2

1 Grammar Past continuous vs. simple past

A Listen to a conversation about a thunderstorm. Why does the woman say she has to go?

00:00 01:10



- ○ Because she needed to help her son with his homework
- ◉ Because the lights went out and she couldn't see
- ○ Because her phone had no battery charge left

See answers | Check answers | Clear | Try again

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B Listen again and select the words you hear.

00:00 01:10

1 What **were you doing** when the outage **happened**?

2 I **was cooking** dinner when suddenly the lights **went out**!

3 The lights **went out** while he **was watching** TV.

4 So what **did you do** when the lights **went out**?

5 I **found** a flashlight and some candles.

See answers | Check answers | Clear | Try again

Common mistakes | Sentences, exercise B

1 Grammar Past continuous vs. simple past

C Answer a–e about the sentences in B. Then complete f with the correct tenses.

a In 2 and 3, which two actions were in progress? What verb form do they use?
I was cooking , he was watching : past continuous

b What action interrupted them? What verb form is used for that action?
the lights went out : simple past

c Which two words in 1–4 connect the two clauses? when :
while

d In 4, does *when* mean "after" or "at the same time"? after

e Is 5 an action in progress or a result? a result

f So, for actions in progress use past continuous , and for actions that interrupt use simple past . For resulting actions use simple past .

See answers | Check answers | Clear | Try again

1 Grammar Past continuous vs. simple past

E Check the best options to complete the picture story. Listen to check.

00:00 00:56



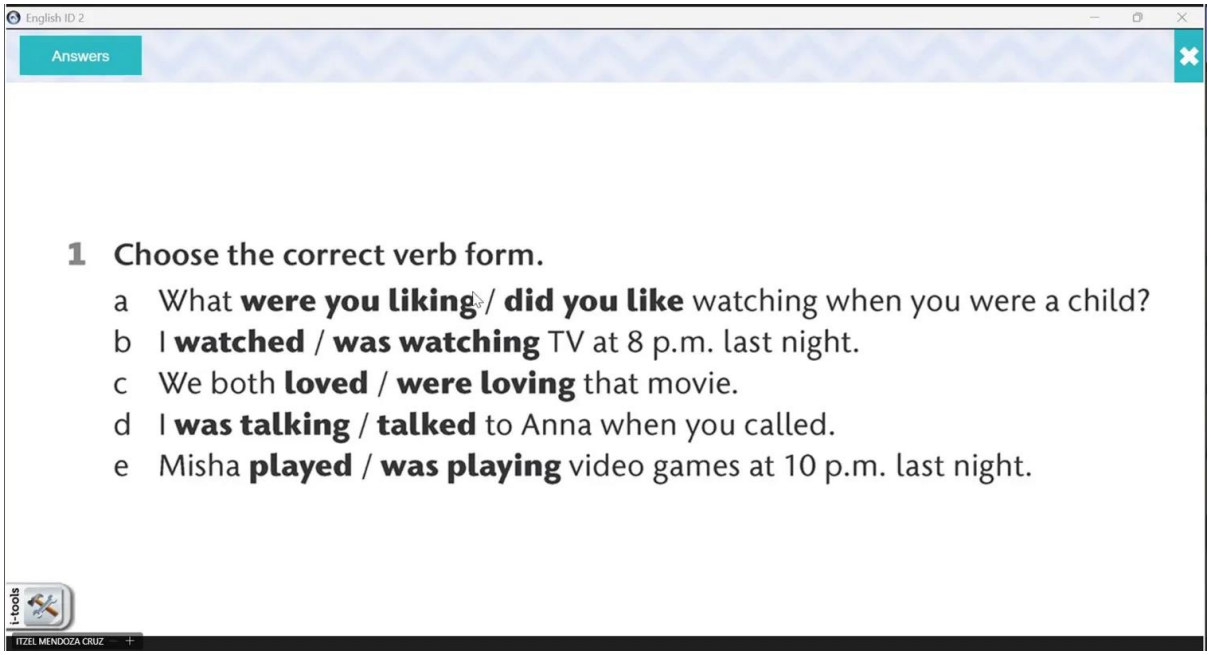
- [x] Jane was chatting online when her phone rang.
- [ ] Jane's phone was ringing when she chatted online.

- [ ] Her mom was coming in when she talked on the phone.
- [x] Her mom came in when she was talking on the phone.

- [ ] When she was hanging up, her mom read her emails.
- [x] When she hung up, her mom was reading her emails.

- [x] Her parents were talking when Jane went downstairs.
- [ ] Her parents talked when Jane was going downstairs.

See answers | Check answers | Clear | Try again



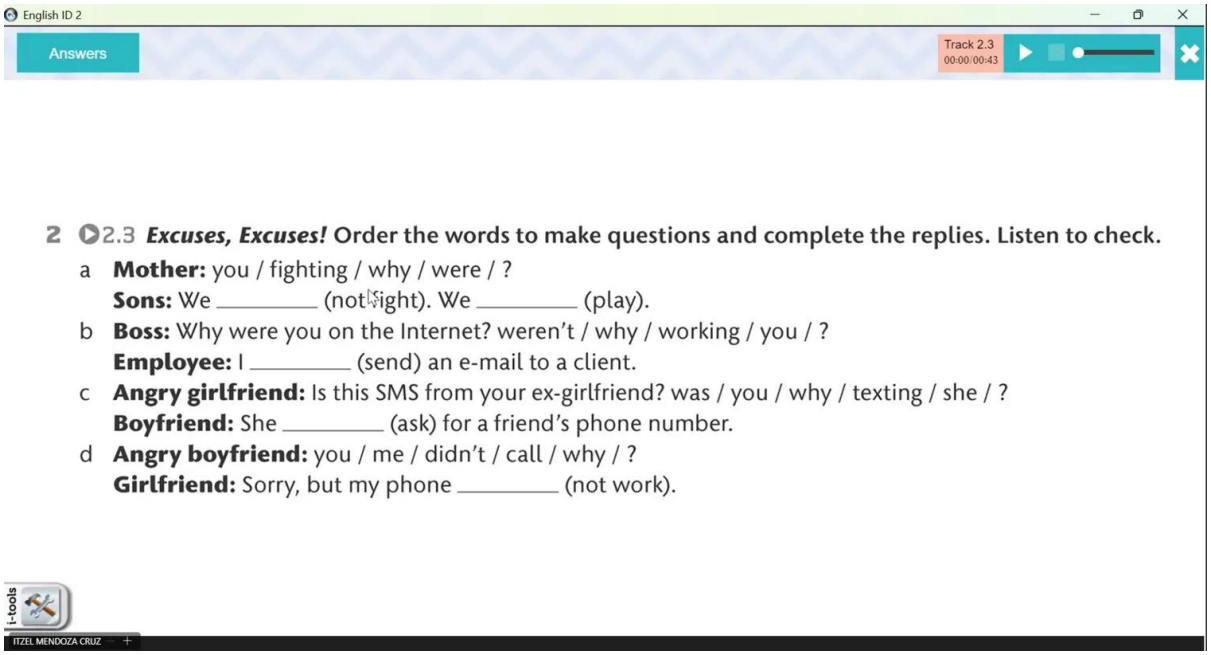
1.-What **did you like** watching when you were a child?

2.- I **was watching** TV at 8 p.m. last night.

3.- We both **loved** that movie.

4.- I **was talking** to Anna when you called.

5.- Misha **was playing** video games at 10 p.m. last night.

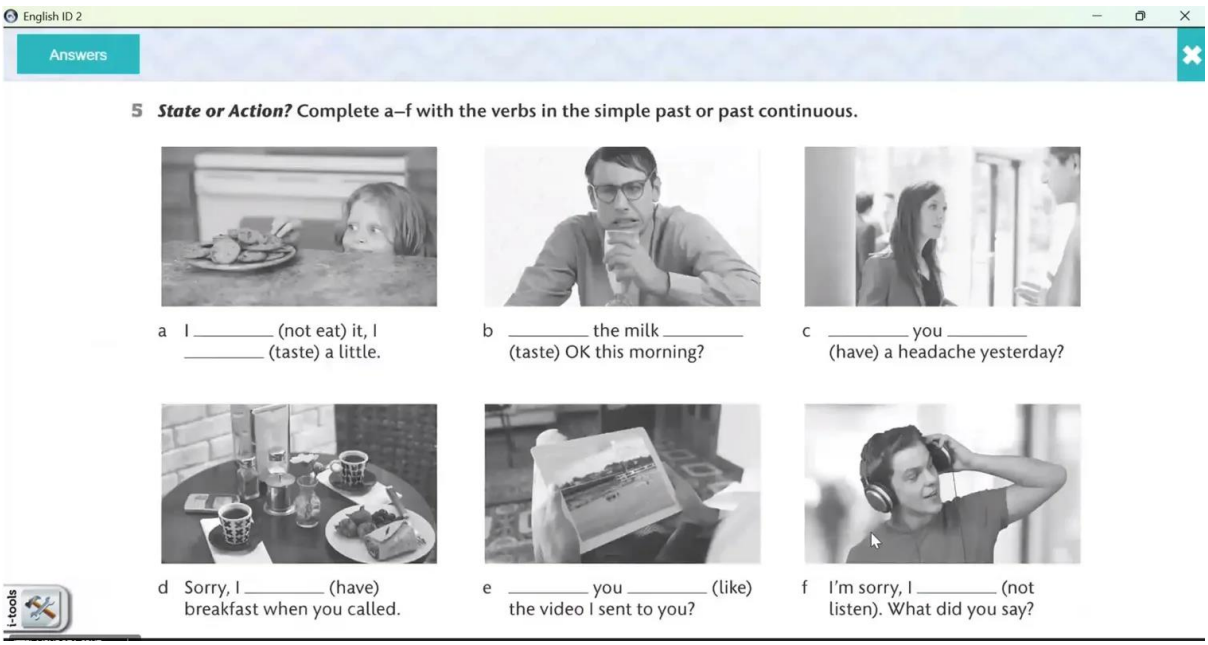


1.- **Mother:** Why were you fighting? **Sons:** We **weren't fighting** (not fight). We **were playing** (play).

2.- **Boss:** Why weren't you working? **Employee:** I **was sending** (send) an e-mail to a client.

3.- **Angry girlfriend:** Why was she texting you? **Boyfriend:** She **was asking** (ask) for a friend's phone number.

4.- **Angry boyfriend:** Why didn't you call me? **Girlfriend:** Sorry, but my phone **wasn't working** (not work).



A) I **didn't eat** it, I **was tasting** a little.

B) **Did** the milk **taste** OK this morning?
C) **Did** you **have** a headache yesterday?
D) Sorry, I **was having** breakfast when you called.
E) **Did** you **like** the video I sent to you?
F) I'm sorry, I **wasn't listening**. What did you say?